to transgress these boundaries.[63] Lorde reimagines and places her nightingale in Berlin's Cold War urban context.

Lorde's wall crossing is imagined through undermining the systems of border control in a dreamed excursion that culminates in another moment of potential flight. By previously spatializing and grounding her poem with closing mentions of the nightingale near a street "corner" and "the hair-bouncing step / of a jaunty flower-bandit" (an opaque reference to Dagmar Schultz),[64] the nightingale pauses for her in the alley, symbolizing escape, restraint, and comfort. Here, the city's hard edges—of history, of the Berlin Wall—make stone and concrete important material referents to Lorde's poetry in and of Berlin, as does the potential for soothing, softness, comfort, and flight from that very haunted and politicized urban topography.

Part of Lorde's complex and haunted relationship with Berlin was also connected to the public memory of the Holocaust. The city is where Lorde suggested she was "listening to what fear teaches" and remained as a "scar" in a place in which hatred and the afterlife of war remain as forces in the landscape. As in the poetic navigation of "Berlin Is Hard on Colored Girls," Lorde extended her own exploration of the divided city in another poem, "This Urn Contains Earth from German Concentration Camps: Plotzensee Memorial, West Berlin, 1984." Located on a lake in northwest West Berlin, Plötzensee was a former Nazi prison and execution house. In 1952 it was dedicated as a memorial to those persecuted by the Third Reich.[65] During Lorde's 1984 trip, the Plötzensee Memorial was West Berlin's most prominent remembrance of the Holocaust. As Lorde's title suggests, the site marks memory of the Holocaust by incorporating earth from each German concentration camp into a large urn at the entrance with an inscribed plaque in German from which the name of the poem is based. Lorde visited the site and retained copies of the memorial's takeaway pamphlet in her records.[66] It was one of the only sites in West Berlin in which she could discern public inscription to Holocaust trauma and memory. She began drafting her reflections as a journal entry while considering her own comforts and reservations at the close of her time in Berlin. On July 29, 1984, she wrote in her unpublished journal of the bland character of the memorial site. In particular, she located the urn as an unintentional symbol of the site's silences and disavowals regarding anti-Semitic violence. Lorde's identification with Jewish victims of Nazi tyranny was also connected to her concerns about contemporary racism in Germany.[67] Lorde connects her